DEDAT INTRANET — NORTHERN CAPE DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND TOURISM

User Guide

How to use the DEDaT Intranet - for staff and Administrators

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End User Guide

A practical manual for using the DEDaT Intranet — written for staff, not developers. Admin-only steps are clearly marked; everything else applies to every logged-in staff member.

1. Logging in

1. Open the intranet in your browser.
2. Enter your government email (`name@ncdedat.gov.za`) and password.
3. Click **Login**.

If you don't have an account yet, click **Sign Up** — you can only self-register if your employee record already exists in the system (ask your Admin if registration says your employee record wasn't found).

Forgot your password? Click **Forgot Password** on the login screen, enter your email, and a reset link will be sent to you (or, if your organization hasn't configured email yet, ask your IT administrator for it). The reset page asks for a new password (minimum 8 characters) twice.

2. Logging out

Click your name/initials in the top-right corner, then **Logout**. Closing the browser tab also ends your session — logins don't persist across browser restarts by design.

3. Navigating the application

The top navigation bar links to every page you have access to: Home, About, Calendar, News and Circulars, Programs and Units, Staff Directory, Knowledge Center, Dashboard. The orange bar underneath holds shortcut buttons (Policies, Wellness, Help Desk, and a few links to external systems). If you're an Admin, you'll also see **Admin Center** and **Add Content**.

4. Reading News and Circulars

Go to **News and Circulars**. The featured story appears as a large banner at the top; everything else is shown as cards below it. Use the category filters (All/News/Circulars/Events/Training) or the search box to narrow things down. Click any article's title or image to open the **full article** — not just a summary — with the complete story, image, author, and publish date. Official circulars and gazettes are listed separately below the news grid, each with a button to view/download the PDF.

5. Viewing employee information (Staff Directory)

Go to **Staff Directory**. Search by name, skill, or programme, or use the filter dropdowns (department, skill category) and the "Mentor Only" switch. Each result card shows the person's role, department, skills, and a **Contact** button that opens an email to them, plus a **Copy Email** button.

6. Wellness videos

Go to **Wellness**. Browse or search the webinar library, filter by category (Mental Health / Productivity / Physical Care), and click **Watch Now** on any video card to open it in a player. Videos either play directly or open as an embedded YouTube/Vimeo player, depending on how the Admin added them — either way, press play yourself; nothing autoplays with sound. Close the player with the ✕ button or by pressing Escape.

7. Reading Policies, FAQ, and the Knowledge Centre

- **Policies** — browse official policy documents; each one links to its PDF.
- **FAQ** — questions are grouped by category; expand a question to read its answer.
- **Knowledge Center** — guides and resources, each with a description and an attached document.

8. Calendar and boardroom booking

Go to **Calendar**. Browse events by month, filter by category, and search by title. Click any day to open the booking form — fill in a title, start/end time, and category, then save. **Any staff member can book the boardroom** (it's a shared resource, not an Admin-only action) — the system automatically rejects a booking that overlaps an existing boardroom booking for the same time slot.

9. Your profile

Click your name in the top-right, then **View Profile**. You can update your own first name, surname, programme, sub-programme, and position. You cannot change your own role or email from here — contact an Admin for either.

10. Programmes & Units

Shows each department's real information (name, description, how many employees are currently assigned) — the data here comes directly from what Admins manage in Admin Center → Departments, so it's always current.

For Admins: managing content and the organization

Everything above still applies to you — this section covers what's *additionally* available once your account has the Admin role.

11. Add Content

Click **Add Content** (bottom nav bar). Pick a content type on the left (News & Circulars, FAQ, Knowledge Centre, Policies, Wellness, Calendar Event), fill in the form, and click **Publish**. Long-text fields use a formatting toolbar (bold, italic, headings, lists, links) — no need to know Markdown. Every type except Calendar Events has a **Visibility** setting: choose **Draft** to save it without showing it to staff yet, or **Published** to make it visible immediately. Two quick-link buttons at the top jump straight to managing Employees or Departments instead.

Below the News and Wellness forms, a **Manage Existing…** table lists everything already published (including Drafts) with buttons to **Edit**, **Publish/Unpublish**, or **Delete** each item.

12. Admin Center

Click **Admin Center** (top or bottom nav). Four tabs:

- **Overview** — live counts: active employees, active accounts, departments, and how many employees don't have a login yet.
- **Employees** — search/filter the full directory, add a new employee, edit an existing one, or deactivate one (deactivating keeps their history, it doesn't delete them).
- **Users & Roles** — see every account, change someone's role (Employee ↔ Admin), activate/deactivate an account, or **Invite User** to create an account for an existing employee (they'll get an emailed link to set their own password — you never choose it for them).
- **Departments** — add, edit, or deactivate departments. A department with active employees still assigned can't be deactivated until they're reassigned.

Full step-by-step Admin workflows: `ADMIN_USER_GUIDE.md`

Notes on what's not yet available

The **Dashboard** page's HR Services, Wellness Center links, Notices, and Quick Action buttons are placeholders carried over from an early design — they don't connect to any real system yet (the Anonymous Suggestion/ Grievance boxes accept text and show a confirmation message, but nothing is actually sent or stored). There's no leave-management or approvals feature in this version of the intranet.